

Résumé Writing :
Structure and Types

HS110

PURPOSE AND SCOPE

Purpose of writing résumé
-to create interest not tell every detail
Or
-to gain the opportunity for interview

Scope- required through out professional life



MYTHS AND FACTS

Myths or fallacies about Résumé	**Facts**
Purpose is to list your skills and abilities	To generate interest and an interview
A good résumé **will get you the job**	It can only get you an interview call
It will be read carefully and thoroughly	It will make an impression within 30 seconds, or can be scanned by the computer for specific keywords
The more good information you present in the résumé **the better**	Recruiters don't need that much information about you at the initial screening stage, they probably won't read it.
Real good résumés **are prepared by experts or professional**	Trust your understanding and prepare a résumé otherwise many it may have points that may lead to questions.

Résumé and Curriculum Vitae(CV)

- **Bio data (obsolete)**
- Shortened form of biographical data
- Emphasis on personal details such as dob, marital status, gender and address, family

- **Résumé**
- Résumé comes from a French word which means summary.
- Usually one page long, sometimes goes to two pages
- Includes the gist of an individual's education, past employment and skills
- Personal information such as age , dob marital status not included

- **CV**
- Contains all the elements of a resume but it is more detailed in terms of academic credentials
- Contains detailed account of all achievements like seminars, work shop attended; trainings, projects done
- Résumé may just mention it CV gives details

Qualities of a Good CV/ Résumé

Write CV or resume not autobiographies

A resume or CV should reflect the personal image you want to create, therefore it should be:-

- Neat and error- free with no hand corrections
- Legible and well spaced
- Printed on good quality paper (A4)
- Logical structure
- Key information easily highlighted
- No long sentences or passages but point in bullets
- Text lined up or columns
- Consistency of font
- Ideal length of resume 1-2 pages
- CV more the achievement, lengthier the CV.

Parts of a Résumé /CV

- **Personal information-** name, address, phone no. email address and website
- **Career objective** or summary of qualification-(optional) aim and aspiration
- **Education/ academic preparation-** education and training since high school,
  - begin with most recent education and work backward
  - include major and minor field of study

OTHER PARTS

- **Work experience and professional skills**-
  - list of jobs courses or projects done in chronological order, with present or last one first
  - name and location of organization where worked, job profile, designation, duration, responsibilities
  - part time or summer internship projects done
  - no need for complete sentences only phrases
  - use technical terminology

SOME MORE ...

- **Activities, Achievements/, Aptitudes, Memberships-** include only those information the employer will find useful
  - includes special abilities
  - professional courses undertaken
  - community services
  - voluntary activities
  - languages known
  - awards and honours received

MORE PARTS ….

- **Special interests or hobbies**
- **Strengths and Weaknesses**
- **Professional skills / languages known**
- **References**- 2-4 names with details and contact number

Example of Strengths

Team Player
Self motivated
Strong interpersonal skills
Strong communication skills
Leadership qualities
Adaptability
Critical thinking

- Innovative
- Flexibility
- Convincing/ negotiations skills
- Analytical skills
- Perseverance
- Quick thinking
- Problem solving
- Life-long learning skills

Example of Weaknesses

one that you had and are already working to overcome
or
either one that can be converted into a strength

- Impatience- when people take too long to complete a job as I am a fast worker
- Restless- I cannot rest until and unless I finish the work
- Perfectionist- I take long time to finish a task but it is often perfect
- Often trust people too much-
- Curiousity/inquisitiveness- Cannot rest unless have got information

Weaknesses

- Disorganised—Creative
- Inflexible- organised
- Stubborn- dedicated
- Inconsistent- flexible
- Emotionless- calm and analytical
- Shy – reflective and observant
- Irresponsible- Adventurous, risk taking
- Domineering – assertive
- Negative- realistic

TYPES of Résumés

- CHRONOLOGICAL
- FUNCTIONAL
- COMBINATION

CHRONOLOGICAL RÉSUMÉ

- most commonly used format
- gives the data in a reverse chronological order i.e. recent achievements first
- popular with both beginners

ATS (application tracking system)

- Organizations mostly prefer ATS compliant resume
- Applicant tracking systems (ATS) are software tools that help employers collect, filter, and evaluate candidate data
- A chronological resume is the best for ATS

Using ATS

Here are some tips for using ATS keywords:

- Use action verbs: These are useful for describing your skills and work experience
- Consider synonyms and related terms: ATS can use natural language processing (NLP) to understand the context of your resume and recognize synonyms and related terms
- E.g.- Team worker/ collaborative skills

CHRONOLOGICAL RÉSUMÉ

VIBHOR SAXENA
A-25/31, Sector-60, Noida- 201 301
E-mail: vibhor_saxena@dppc.com

POSITION SOUGHT	**Manager-Project**
OBJECTIVE	To contribute to the growth of a leading project management company by working in a challenging position where I will have opportunities to utilise my exposure to project management methodologies and experience as project leader in construction activities of large scale heavy engineering projects.
EXPERIENCE	**Project Leader,** Dharampal Premchand Ltd., Sector-60, Noida-201 301 December 2001 to present • Complete civil projects within or ahead of the schedule through strict planning, monitoring, and control while maintaining the best construction standards • Supervise erection of auxiliary facilities like water treatment, ETP, cabling, piping and other utilities • Maintain customer relations through effective presentation of technical expertise **Assistant Project Manager (Civil),** Subhash Projects and Marketing Ltd, Park Street, Kolkata December 1998 to November 2001 • Assist in the project management of various civil works being executed at site • Coordinate with Head Office, sites, various departments and sub-contractors • Maintain close liaison with clients
EDUCATION	**Pondicherry Engineering College,** Pondicherry B.Tech in Civil Engineering, July 1998 **Institute of Information Technology**, Mumbai Certificate in Computer Programming, December, 1994
SPECIAL SKILLS	• Proficient in MS-DOS, Microsoft Windows, Excel, and Word 98 and 2000 • Good problem-solving skills • Excellent communication and interpersonal skills • Competent in speaking French
ACTIVITIES	• Member, Institution of Engineers, New Delhi • Member, National Cadet Corps, 1994–1996 • Secretary, Society for Promotion of Science, New Delhi
INTERESTS	• Badminton, Football, Cycling • Classical Music, Movies, Fiction

Fig. 23.1 Chronological Résumé

FUNCTIONAL RÉSUMÉ
also called Skills résumé

- focuses on abilities that are specific to the type of position sought for
- presents details skill wise
- suitable for those who want to change their career, have a wide work experience or are applying for jobs that require clearly defined profile and personality traits

FUNCTIONAL RÉSUMÉ

VIBHOR SAXENA
A-25/31, Sector-60, Noida- 201 301
E-mail: vibhor_saxena@dppc.com

POSITION SOUGHT
Manager-Project

OBJECTIVE
To contribute to the growth of a leading project management company by working in a challenging position where I will have opportunities to utilise my exposure to project management methodologies and experience as project leader in construction activities of large scale heavy engineering projects.

PROJECT MANAGEMENT
- Assisted in the project management of various civil works being executed at site at Subhash Projects and Marketing Ltd
- Completed civil projects within or ahead of the schedule at Dharampal Premchand Ltd
- Maintained strict planning, monitoring and control while maintaining the best construction standards
- Supervised erection of auxiliary facilities like water treatment, ETP, cabling, piping, and other utilities

COORDINATION AND CUSTOMER RELATIONS
- Coordinated with Head Office, sites, various departments, and sub-contractors
- Maintained customer relations through effective presentation of technical expertise
- Maintained close liaison with clients

SPECIAL SKILLS
- Proficient in MS-DOS, Microsoft Windows, Excel, and Word 98 and 2000
- Good problem-solving skills
- Excellent communication and interpersonal skill
- Competent in speaking French

EDUCATION
Pondicherry Engineering College, Pondicherry
BTech in Civil Engineering, July 1998
Institute of Information Technology, Mumbai
Certificate in Computer Programming, December, 1994

EMPLOYMENT RECORD

2001/present	**Project Leader**, Dharampal Premchand Ltd., Sector-60, Noida-201 301
1998/2001	**Assistant Project Manager (Civil),** Subhash Projects and Marketing Ltd, Park Street, Kolkata

ACTIVITIES
- Member, Institution of Engineers, New Delhi
- Member, National Cadet Corps, 1994-1996
- Secretary, Society for Promotion of Science. New Delhi

INTERESTS
- Badminton, Football, Cycling
- Classical Music, Movies, Fiction

Fig. 23.2 Functional Résumé

COMBINATION RÉSUMÉ

- includes elements of both the chronological and functional formats
- It may be a shorter chronology of job descriptions preceded by a short ‘Skills and Accomplishments’ section (or with a longer summary including a skills list or a list of ‘qualifications’)
- It may be a standard functional résumé with the accomplishments under headings of different jobs held

COMBINATION RÉSUMÉ

VIBHOR SAXENA
A-25/31, Sector-60, Noida- 201 301
E-mail: vibhor_saxena@dppc.com

SKILLS

- Conversant in structural steel design and fabrication
- Have suf□cient exposure to project management methodologies
- Competent in managing construction activities of large scale Heavy Engineering Projects
- Pro□cient in MS-DOS, Microsoft Windows, Excel, and Word 98 and 2000
- Good problem-solving skills
- Excellent communication and interpersonal skills
- Competent in speaking French

EXPERIENCE

Project Leader, Dharampal Premchand Ltd, Sector-60, Noida-201 301
December 2001 to present

- Complete civil projects within or ahead of the schedule through strict planning, monitoring and control while maintaining the best construction standards
- Supervise erection of auxiliary facilities like water treatment, ETP, cabling, piping and other utilities
- Maintain customer relations through effective presentation of technical expertise

Assistant Project Manager (Civil), Subhash Projects and Marketing Ltd, Park Street, Kolkata

December 1998 to November 2001

- Assist in the project management of various civil works being executed at site
- Coordinate with Head Of□ce, sites, various departments, and sub-contractors.
- Maintain close liaison with clients

EDUCATION

Pondicherry Eng College, Pondicherry
B.Tech in Civil Engineering, July 1998
Institute of Information Technology, Mumbai
Certi□cate in Computer Programming, December, 1994

ACTIVITIES

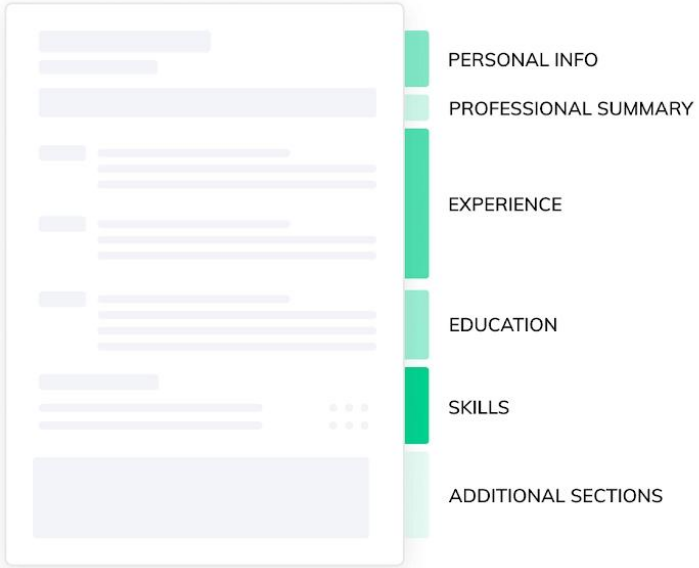
- Member, Institution of Engineers, New Delhi
- Member, National Cadet Corps, 1994-1996
- Secretary, Society for Promotion of Science, New Delhi

INTERESTS

- Badminton, Football, Cycling
- Classical Music, Movies, Fiction

Fig. 23.3 Combination Résumé

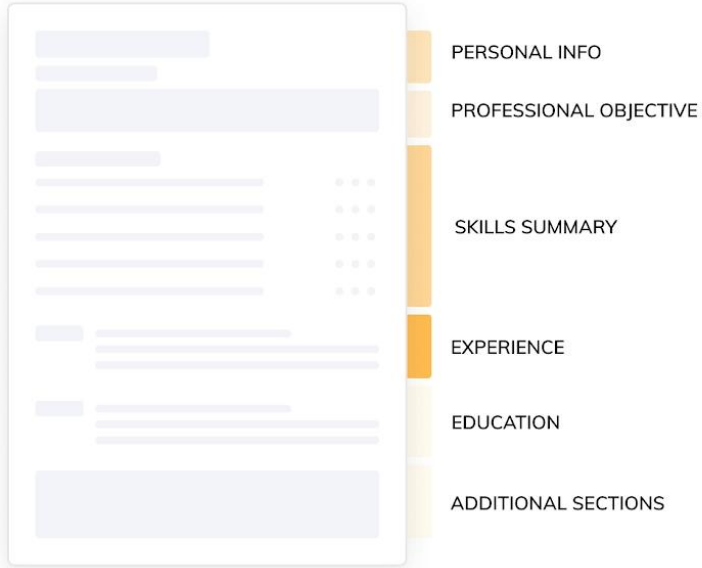
Chronological Resume



IDEAL FOR:

- Candidates seeking a job similar to their previous positions
- Students and entry-level candidates
- Academic resumes

Functional Resume



IDEAL FOR:

- Creative jobs where a portfolio matters most
- Military transitioners
- Candidates who don't want to seem overqualified

Combination Resume



IDEAL FOR:

- Seasoned professionals targetting a specific postition
- Career-changers
- People with employment gaps

RÉSUMÉ FOR A FRESH APPLICANT

- In the absence of experience, employers would be more interested in aspects such as training, projects, education, skills and achievements.
- The layout of the résumé for a new candidate is not much different.
- However, there is a difference in approach and may vary in its presentation.

RÉSUMÉ FOR A FRESH APPLICANT

(a) Career Objective: Express your broad career goals, type of task you would like to do and willingness to learn.

(b) Training: Mention about your training highlighting the training field and what you have gained from it. Use sentences such as 'Received three months training, at …, from … to …, in the field of ….'

Gained knowledge on ….

(c) Education: Provide this information in a little detail, that is, starting from the current; you may go back to 10th.

MORE PARTS ….

(d) Skills and Strengths:, mention your general capabilities and traits relevant to the position, for example, proficient in C++, Excel, Java and MAT Lab/very good at Math and English/logical reasoning/ability to co-relate theory with practical/communication skills/leadership qualities/problem solving skills/keen to learn and so on.

(e) Achievements, Activities and Interests: to be emphasized as companies want people who are all rounders, self-motivated, have a positive attitude and are eager to take challenges.

Use Action words

Use strong action verbs

- Start each bullet point with a strong action verb, such as "delivered", "acquired", "drove", or "optimized".

Avoid clichés and overused words

- Avoid vague language and jargons that could leave the hiring manager unsure of your responsibilities. e.g-worked as, interned

Use action verbs in your work experience section

- Use action verbs to show what you achieved in previous roles.

Some examples of action words : accomplished, actualized, constructed, finalized, fulfilled, handled, increased, prepared, realized, and volunteered.

POWERFUL VERBS YOU CAN USE TO IMPROVE YOUR RESUME



- Assist
- Able
- Action
- Analysis
- Achievement
- Accomplished
- Advanced
- Conduct
- Consult
- Committed
- Conducted
- Contributed
- Coordinated
- Delegated
- Develop
- Deliver
- Design
- Defined
- Diversified
- Devoted
- Distinguished
- Encourage
- Earned
- Enhance
- Evaluate
- Examined
- Facilitate
- Formulate
- Fulfilled
- Forecasted
- Generated
- Gained
- Gathered
- Gave
- Headed
- Hosted
- Identified
- Implemented
- Improved
- Improvised
- Influenced
- Launched
- Lobbied
- Maintained
- Managed
- Marketed
- Maximized
- Mediated
- Modernized
- Motivated
- Negotiated
- Observed
- Obtained
- Operated
- Organized
- Originated
- Overhauled
- Oversaw
- Participated
- Performed
- Pioneered
- Planned
- Prepared
- Presented
- Promoted
- Provided
- Published
- Pursued
- Quantified
- Ranked
- Received
- Recommended
- Redesigned
- Reengineered
- Reorganized
- Represented
- Restructured
- Revised
- Safeguarded
- Secured
- Selected
- Specified
- Spearheaded
- Standardized
- Strengthened
- Structured
- Suggested
- Superseded
- Supervised
- Targeted
- Taught
- Tested
- Trained
- Transcended
- Unified
- Upgraded
- Utilized
- Validated
- Valued
- Wrote

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